

Richard Carlile

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Richard Carlile (1790–1843) was a publisher and campaigner for free speech. After moving to London in 1813, he was inspired by the writings of Tom Paine and, in 1817, founded the radical newspaper *The Republican* in Fleet Street.

Carlile was imprisoned in 1819 for publishing views that criticised the government and the Church. While he was in prison, his wife Jane and sister Mary continued publishing the newspaper. Despite government attempts to suppress it, *The Republican* remained popular.

Carlile later supported women's rights and freedom of expression. Although he faced imprisonment and poverty, he helped advance press freedom in Britain.

The website includes a picture of Richard Carlile and a picture of 62 Fleet Street, which was decorated with a protest display.



Richard Carlile (left); his offices at 62 Fleet Street with a tableau protesting against church tithes (right) Note bishop with devil in left first floor window.